Nursery ponds: The hatchlings are transferred from hatching pits after 2 to 7 days. The hatchlings grow into fry and are cultured in these ponds for about 60 days with proper feeding till they reach 2 - 2.5 cm in length.

Rearing ponds: Rearing ponds are used to culture the fry. The fish fry are transferred from nursery pond to rearing ponds and are maintained for about three months till they reach 10 to 15 cm in length. In these rearing ponds the fry develops into fingerlings.

Stocking pond: The stocking pond is also called as culture pond or production pond. These ponds are used to rear fingerlings upto the marketable size.

23.11.3 Cultivable Food Fishes

Freshwater cultivable fishes: Indian major carps (Kendai) – Catla, Rohu, Mrigal, catfishes (Keluthi), Murrels (Veral) and Tilapia (Jilebi kendai) are cultured in freshwater.

Marine water cultivable fishes: Sea bass (Koduva), Grey mullet (Madavai) and *Chanos chanos* (Milk fish) are the fishes cultured in marine water.

23.11.4 Nutritional Value of Fishes

Cultivable freshwater and marine food fishes are highly nutritious, rich source of animal proteins and are easily digestible. They are rich in essential amino acids such as lysine and methionine, polyunsaturated fatty acid (PUFA), minerals like calcium, phosphorus, iron, sodium, potassium and magnesium. Fat soluble vitamins A, D and water soluble B-complex vitamins like pyridoxine, cyanocobalamine and niacin.

Activity 3

Visit a fish farm near your locality and collect information about the following:
a) Different types of pond you see. b) Different varieties of fishes in the pond. c) Type of feed and their ingredients used to prepare feed.

23.12 Prawn Culture

One of the most economically important shell fish resources of India are prawns. They are of great demand both in the local and international market. Due to their great taste, they are a cherished delicacy to be served as food. In view of their popularity and marketing avenues in foreign countries there is a need for developing advanced technology and intensify prawn culture in India.

23.12.1 Types of Prawn Culture

A number of species of prawns of different sizes are found distributed in water resources. Only those prawns which are good in size, weight, available in plenty and easily cultivable are commonly selected for prawn culture on commercial basis.

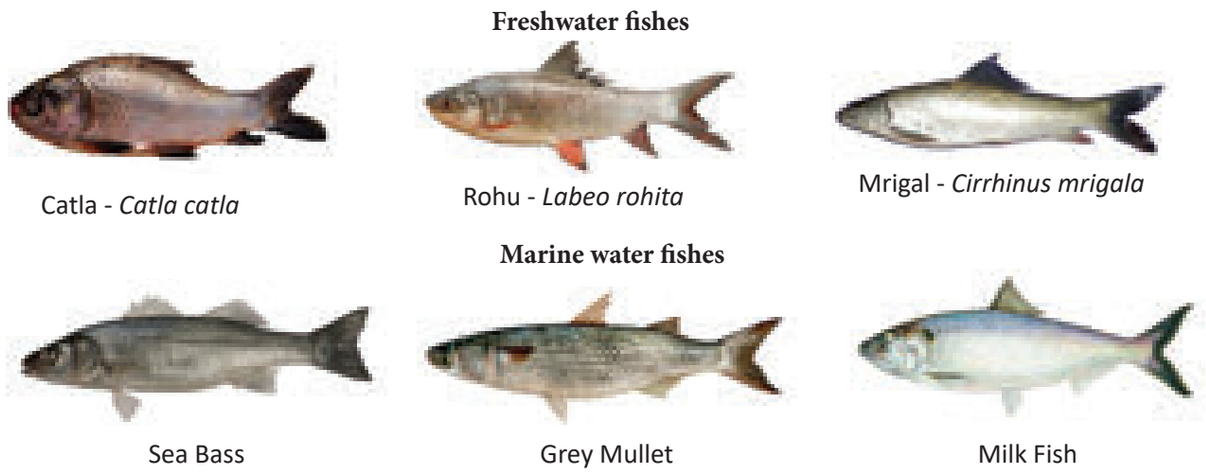


Figure 23.16 Freshwater and Marine water fishes

IX_SCI_EM_Unit-23_BIO.indd 282 06-02-2020 13:30:37